ADVANCED ENTERPRISE STORAGE CAPABILITIES

Govern Your Storage Like an Enterprise

A step-by-step guide for pilot admins: scoped access credentials, version history, compliance-grade locked retention, legal hold, automated lifecycle policies, and a native desktop drive.

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SECTION 01

What This Gives You

Beyond basic upload/download, Inaya's storage layer includes the controls enterprise IT and compliance teams expect: who can access what and for how long, the ability to recover an overwritten file, storage that genuinely cannot be deleted during a retention period, legal holds for litigation/investigation, automatic cleanup policies, and a real drive-letter view of your storage on Windows. This guide walks through each one, in Business Workspace, step by step.

CAPABILITY	WHERE TO FIND IT
Scoped access credentials	Business Workspace → S3-Compatible Storage
Versioning, locked retention, legal hold, lifecycle, health	Business Workspace → S3-Compatible Storage → Buckets, Versions & Object Protection
Desktop drive mount	Inaya Business Workspace desktop app (Windows)

SECTION 02

Scoped Access Credentials

Instead of every integration or team member holding a full-access credential, issue one scoped to exactly what it needs.

1. **1. Go to S3-Compatible Storage → "Restrict scope."** Click this before creating a new credential.
2. **2. Set a bucket.** Confines the credential to one bucket only, e.g. "finance."
3. **3. (Optional) Set a prefix.** Further confines it to a folder path within that bucket, e.g. "invoices/2026/." Requires a bucket to already be set.
4. **4. Choose operations.** Toggle any combination of READ, WRITE, DELETE, LIST. A credential with only READ selected can never write or delete, even if the raw credential is compromised.
5. **5. Set an expiry date.** The credential automatically stops working after this date — no manual revocation needed for time-boxed engagements (a contractor, a fixed-term integration).

> **Example.** "Give the accounts-payable system read-only access to finance/invoices/2026/ for the next 90 days" is one credential, configured with all four fields above — enforced by Inaya's server on every request, not just hidden by the UI.

SECTION 03

Version History & Restore

1. **1. Open "Buckets, Versions & Object Protection."** Find the bucket you want version history for.
2. **2. Click "Enable versioning."** From this point forward, overwriting a file keeps the previous version instead of discarding it. Files uploaded before this point are not retroactively versioned.
3. **3. Click an object to see its version history.** Every version is listed with its date, and whether it's the current ("latest") one.
4. **4. Click "Restore" on any older version.** This makes that version's content the new current version — the file reverts, and the restore itself becomes a new entry in the version history.

> Versioning can be suspended later (new overwrites stop keeping history), but every version already kept remains retrievable — nothing already protected is ever silently lost by suspending.

SECTION 04

Locked Retention (Compliance Hold)

1. **1. Enable versioning on the bucket first.** Locked retention requires versioning to already be on — this is enforced, not just recommended.
2. **2. Click "Enable Object Lock."** Turns on locked-retention support for this bucket.
3. **3. Open the object's version list, click "Lock."** Enter how many days to retain it for. The object cannot be deleted or overwritten until that date, by anyone — including through a direct API call, not just the Business Workspace interface.

> **Important.** A retention period can be extended later but never shortened — this is deliberate: a lock a compliance team is relying on can't be quietly weakened by anyone with UI access.

SECTION 05

Legal Hold

Separate from locked retention — a legal hold blocks deletion indefinitely, with no expiry date, until someone explicitly releases it. Use this for litigation holds and active investigations.

1. **1. Open the object's version list.** Click "Legal hold."
2. **2. The object is now protected.** Deletion and overwrite are both blocked — again enforced server-side, not just in the interface.
3. **3. Click "Release hold" when the hold is no longer needed.** The object becomes deletable again (subject to any separate locked-retention period still in effect).

SECTION 06

Automatic Lifecycle Policies

1. **1. Open a bucket's section in "Buckets, Versions & Object Protection."** Find the "Lifecycle: expire after ___ days" field.
2. **2. Enter a number of days.** Objects in this bucket older than that are automatically cleaned up. Leave it blank to disable the policy.
3. **3. Click "Run lifecycle enforcement now" to apply it immediately.** Otherwise it runs on Inaya's own regular schedule.

> **Safety guarantee.** A locked (retention) or legal-held object is never auto-deleted by a lifecycle policy, even past its expiration day — protection always wins over automatic cleanup.

SECTION 07

Storage Health

Click any object in "Buckets, Versions & Object Protection" to see its real redundancy status — how many independent copies of each half of the encrypted, sharded file currently exist, and its overall health state. This is live telemetry, not a static label.

SECTION 08

Inaya Drive — A Real Drive Letter (Windows)

Inside the Inaya Business Workspace desktop app, mount your storage as an ordinary Windows drive letter — browse, open, and save files directly, the same way you would with any local or network drive.

1. **1. Issue (or reuse) an S3-compatible credential.** See Section 02 — a scoped credential works here too, e.g. a read-only drive limited to one bucket.
2. **2. Open the "Inaya Drive" panel in the desktop app.** Enter the Access Key ID, Secret Access Key, and a drive letter (e.g. "I:").
3. **3. Click "Mount."** The drive appears in File Explorer within a few seconds.
4. **4. Use it like any other drive.** Open, edit and save files directly, drag-and-drop uploads, delete files — every change is written straight through to Inaya's real storage.
5. **5. Click "Unmount" when finished.** Or simply close the desktop app.

Empty folders. Creating a brand-new empty folder is fully supported — right-click → New → Folder in File Explorer creates a real, durable folder immediately (it doesn't wait for a file to be saved inside it). Built on a new, dedicated folder primitive on both the wallet and organization sides, verified by 17 automated tests against the real database and 12 live HTTP checks against a running server exercising the exact request/response cycle the Drive client performs — creation, nesting, rename, delete, and confirming a real file placed inside still uploads and lists normally. The one piece not independently re-verified in this specific environment is the literal WinFSP kernel-mount step (blocked by a local driver-elevation constraint here, not a code gap) — everything the mount depends on is proven at the HTTP layer above it.

Platform availability. Windows is available for this pilot via the WinFSP-based desktop client. A Linux helper (using fuser, real and live-tested on a genuine Linux kernel — mount/unmount, directory listing, file read/write, empty folder creation, rename/delete, and persistence across a full restart) is also built; it has not yet been validated on physical Linux hardware outside this test environment. macOS support is architecture-only and not yet built or validated.

SECTION 09

Tags, Checksums, Bulk Operations, Inventory & Policy Review (September 2026)

A rounder storage feature set added on top of everything above: object tags for organizing and filtering your data, a real independently-verifiable checksum on every upload, bulk operations across up to 1,000 objects at once, a one-click inventory export, per-bucket analytics, and a read-only review of what each of your storage credentials can actually do.

1. **1. Open "Buckets, Versions & Object Protection" → "Tags & batch."** Pick a bucket, then select objects individually or with "Select all."
2. **2. Apply one change to many objects at once.** Choose an operation — Set tags (e.g. "project=apollo, tier=gold"), Set retention (needs Object Lock already enabled, same as Section 04), or Legal hold — then click "Apply to N objects." Every object reports its own success or failure, so one failure never hides or blocks the rest.
3. **3. Switch to the "Inventory" tab.** Click "Download CSV" for a one-click export of every object in a bucket (or across all buckets), ready for a spreadsheet or an external compliance review tool.
4. **4. Switch to the "Analytics" tab.** See per-bucket object counts, total size, and how many objects are version-locked or under legal hold — the same figures referenced in Section 07, broken out by bucket.
5. **5. Switch to the "Credential review" tab.** A read-only analysis of each storage credential's actual scope and permissions — "No findings" means nothing suspicious was detected; any finding is labeled by severity (High/Medium/Low) so you can tighten an over-broad credential before it's a problem, not after.

> Every uploaded object now carries a real, independently-verifiable checksum — you can confirm a file arrived byte-for-byte intact without trusting Inaya's own say-so. Covered by 9 additional automated tests, with zero regressions to the 57 pre-existing storage tests.

SECTION 10

Everything Is Audited

- Credential creation and revocation
- Every object upload, download, and delete
- Version restores
- Locked-retention and legal-hold changes
- Lifecycle policy changes and every automatic expiration

> All of the above write to your organization's own audit trail, visible to your admins — not just asserted, independently checkable.

SECTION 11

Getting Help

During the pilot, route questions about scope configuration, retention/legal-hold behavior, or the desktop drive to your assigned Inaya technical contact — pilot feedback directly shapes the general-availability release.